MP: RECLAIMING THE CITADEL PG 8

ASSAM: THE HIMANTA ROCK SHOW PG 12

UPFRONT

MP: THE RAJA'S LAST STAND PG 10

GUJARAT: THE SAFFRON ONSLAUGHT PG 14

THE MAYA TWISTER

BSP chief Mayawati's allotment of seats keeping in mind sundry caste configurations could disrupt the plans of the NDA and INDIA alliances in Uttar Pradesh

By Prashant Srivastava

Bahujan Samaj Party (BSP) supremo Mayawati may have been late to the election jamboree in Uttar Pradesh, but that hasn't stopped her from creating a stir in the electoral battlefield of 2024. What till now appeared to be a direct fight between the Bharatiya Janata Party-led National Democratic Alliance and the Samajwadi Party-led Indian National Developmental Inclusive Alliance suddenly acquired a new twist after the BSP announced its candidates. Bucking the perception of being the BJP's 'B' team, the party seems bent on spoiling their prospects, not just in the west but also in Purvanchal (eastern UP).

The BSP's latest shocker has been giving the Jaunpur LS ticket to Srikala Reddy, wife of mafia don-turned-politician Dhananjay Singh. The contest in this eastern UP constituency had looked like a straight fight between the BJP's Kripa Shankar Singh, a former Maharashtra home minister but a native, and the Samajwadi Party's Babu Singh Kushwaha after Dhananjay had been taken out of the equation



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A NEW WAVE? BSP chief Mayawati at a party rally in Amroha, Apr. 21